

PIRATES

Pirates is a monster supplement for 5e that presents pirates as a structured, escalating threat rather than a handful of interchangeable cutlass-wielders. Instead of relying on a single generic pirate stat block, this book provides a full ladder of pirate roles—from powder monkeys and dock ruffians to boarding sergeants, captains, and legendary terrors of the coast—each designed to fill a distinct function during play.

The intent of this product is encounter control and tactical variety. Each pirate type supports a specific style of engagement: mob pressure, ranged volleys, boarding actions, command and morale, area denial, or decisive leadership. Allegiances, flags, and motivations are intentionally undefined, allowing these stat blocks to represent smugglers, privateers, corsairs, naval mutineers, or infamous sea raiders. These pirates are tools of violence, discipline, and ambition—who they serve, what they raid, and why they fight is left entirely in the GM's hands.

PIRATE LADDER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Pirate Powder Monkey	0	Noncombatant youth who carries powder and shot. Their injury or death often provokes violent reactions from nearby crew.
Pirate Deckhand	0	Sailor or laborer without formal combat training, armed only with tools or improvised weapons.
Pirate Cabin Boy	1/8	Young shiphand armed with a knife. Quick and nervous, more likely to flee than fight.
Pirate Dock Ruffian	1/8	Shore-side thug accustomed to brawls and ambushes but lacking discipline.
Pirate Crewman	1/4	Standard pirate armed with a cutlass and sidearm. Fights best in groups.
Pirate Boarding Hand	1/4	Aggressive melee fighter trained to grapple, shove, and overwhelm enemies during boarding actions.
Pirate Gunner	1/2	Crew member trained with pistols or muskets, providing deadly ranged fire before closing in.
Pirate Rigging Fighter	1/2	Agile skirmisher who uses ropes and rigging to gain height, mobility, and positional advantage.
Pirate Swashbuckler	1	Mobile duelist who relies on speed, footwork, and opportunistic strikes.
Pirate Grenadier	1	Specialist who uses black powder bombs, fire pots, and smoke to disrupt formations.
Pirate Harpooner	2	Heavy melee combatant who uses barbed weapons to restrain, pull, or drag enemies.
Pirate Quartermaster	2	Veteran organizer who controls supplies and morale, bolstering nearby allies through command and discipline.
Pirate Veteran	3	Hardened survivor of countless battles, capable of parrying blows and pressing the attack.
Pirate Boarding Sergeant	3	Front-line leader who directs crew movement and coordinates assaults.
Pirate Master Gunner	4	Expert artilleryman who controls cannons and heavy shipboard weapons with deadly efficiency.
Pirate First Mate	4	Trusted second-in-command who coordinates crew actions and reacts swiftly to threats.
Pirate Champion	5	Elite duelist renowned for personal combat prowess and fearlessness.
Pirate Shock Trooper	5	Brutal enforcer trained to smash enemy lines and seize control of key positions.
Pirate Bosun Enforcer	6	Officer who maintains discipline through intimidation, punishment, and ruthless example.
Pirate Veteran Captain	6	Experienced ship captain skilled in tactics, positioning, and crew coordination.
Pirate Captain	7	Charismatic leader whose presence inspires allies and breaks enemy resolve.
Pirate Dread Privateer	7	Licensed raider who combines military discipline with merciless efficiency.
Pirate Iron Captain	8	Heavily armored commander who dominates firefights and close-quarters combat alike.
Pirate Reaver Lord	9	Infamous pirate leader whose reputation alone can unnerve seasoned foes.
Pirate Warlord	10	Supreme commander of multiple crews, capable of directing large-scale engagements.
Pirate Fleet Admiral	11	Master of naval warfare who commands ships, artillery, and disciplined crews with precision.
Pirate Terror of the Coast	12	Legendary pirate whose name is synonymous with devastation, fear, and total control of the battlefield.

PISTOLS, MUSKETS, AND CANNONS

Firearms and artillery are described in the Dungeon Master's Guide.

PIRATE DECKHAND

PIRATE DECKHAND

Medium humanoid (any), unaligned

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 9 (2d8)

Speed 30 ft., swim 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +3, Perception +2

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (0 XP)

Noncombatant. The pirate deckhand avoids direct combat. It has disadvantage on attack rolls and does not willingly move toward hostile creatures unless forced or commanded by an allied officer.

Shiphand. The pirate deckhand has advantage on Strength (Athletics) checks made to climb, pull ropes, or move through difficult terrain created by rigging, cargo, or crowded decks.

ACTIONS

Improvised Tool. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

REACTIONS

Scatter. When the pirate deckhand takes damage, it can use its reaction to move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

- Rank-and-file sailors focused on ship operation rather than combat.
- Shiphand keeps them effective in rigging-heavy environments.
- Scatter reflects chaotic retreats during boarding actions.



PIRATE SWASHBUCKLER

PIRATE SWASHBUCKLER

Medium humanoid (any), unaligned

Armor Class 14 (leather armor)

Hit Points 39 (6d8 + 12)

Speed 30 ft., swim 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

Skills Acrobatics +5, Athletics +3, Perception +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Duelist's Advantage. The pirate swashbuckler has advantage on melee attack rolls against a creature if no other hostile creatures are within 5 feet of the pirate swashbuckler.

Sea Legs. The pirate swashbuckler has advantage on Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks made to keep its footing on difficult or moving terrain created by ships, rigging, or waves.

Brace for Terror. While the pirate swashbuckler can see an allied officer or captain within 30 feet, it has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The pirate swashbuckler makes two melee attacks.

Rapier. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Fancy Footwork. The pirate swashbuckler can take the Disengage action as a bonus action on each of its turns.

- Agile duelists who thrive in one-on-one shipboard combat.
- Duelist's Advantage rewards isolation and precise positioning.
- Excellent skirmishers and officers' champions during boarding actions.



PIRATE MASTER GUNNER

PIRATE MASTER GUNNER

Medium humanoid (any), unaligned

Armor Class 14 (studded leather)

Hit Points 93 (11d8 + 44)

Speed 30 ft., swim 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Athletics +4, Perception +3, Vehicles (water) +4

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Sea Legs. The pirate master gunner has advantage on Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks made to keep its footing on difficult or moving terrain created by ships, rigging, or waves.

Artillery Expert. The pirate master gunner has advantage on attack rolls made with ship-mounted siege weapons it operates. Loading or aiming a siege weapon does not cost the pirate master gunner extra actions beyond those normally required.

Explosive Discipline. The pirate master gunner and allied pirates within 10 feet have advantage on saving throws against effects created by cannons, powder charges, or alchemical fire.

Brace for Terror. While the pirate master gunner can see an allied officer or captain within 30 feet, it has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The pirate master gunner makes two attacks, either two ranged attacks or one ranged attack and one melee attack.

Musket (Reload 1). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 40/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d12 + 2) piercing damage.

Pistol (Reload 1). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30/90 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d10 + 2) piercing damage.

Cutlass. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

- Senior artillery specialists who dominate naval engagements.
- Artillery Expert makes ship-mounted weapons terrifyingly accurate.
- Best positioned near cannons, powder stores, and firing decks.



PIRATE WARLORD

PIRATE WARLORD

Medium humanoid (any), unaligned

Armor Class 18 (breastplate)

Hit Points 212 (17d8 + 136)

Speed 30 ft., swim 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	24 (+7)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +9, Dex +7, Con +11, Wis +7, Cha +8

Skills Athletics +9, Perception +7, Insight +7, Intimidation +8, Vehicles (Water) +9

Senses passive Perception 17

Languages Common

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP)

Sea Legs. The pirate warlord has advantage on Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks made to keep its footing on difficult or moving terrain created by ships, rigging, or waves.

Iron Resolve. The pirate warlord has advantage on saving throws against being frightened and charmed.

Warlord's Presence. Allied pirates within 30 feet of the pirate warlord gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls, and they have advantage on saving throws against being frightened while the warlord isn't incapacitated.

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If the pirate warlord fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The pirate warlord makes three attacks: two with its saber and one with its pistol.

Saber. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (1d8 + 8) slashing damage.

Pistol (Reload 1). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, range 30/90 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d10 + 6) piercing damage.

REACTIONS

Commanding Strike. When an allied pirate the warlord can see within 30 feet hits a creature with a weapon attack, the warlord can use its reaction to allow another allied pirate within 30 feet to make one weapon attack against the same target.

Battlefield Command. When an allied pirate within 30 feet makes a weapon attack, the warlord can cause that attack to deal an extra 13 (3d8) damage.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This pirate can take 2 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. This pirate regains spent legendary actions at the start of their turn.

Command Ally (1 Legendary Action). The pirate warlord chooses one allied pirate it can see within 30 feet. That ally can immediately move up to half its speed or make one weapon attack.

Press the Advantage (1 Legendary Action). The pirate warlord makes one weapon attack.

Reposition the Line (2 Legendary Actions). The pirate warlord and up to two allied pirates it can see within 30 feet can each move up to half their speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

- Apex mundane commander; no spells, pure pressure and coordination.
- Battlefield Command + Commanding Strike enable brutal action economy spikes.
- Designed to anchor full pirate encounters as a decisive centerpiece.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

[Pirate Cove](#): Maps specifically for pirate encounters and adventures.

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